

Task 4.

You'll read an article about an interesting humanitarian mission. Mark the right answer (A, B or C). There is an example (0) for you.

Healing amid hardship

Doctor Anna Jakkel has made six visits to Africa on a voluntary basis to help with medical problems there, and a selection of her photographs has gone on museum display. Dr Jakkel has lent her efforts in Congo, Mali, Guinea, Uganda and Malawi, going once or twice a year for two or three weeks each time. Her pictures show simple rural life with thatched mud huts, wells, venerable people with timeworn faces and charming children.

In one shot, a Ugandan child is wearing a Minnie Mouse T-shirt in Uganda but otherwise there is minimal indication of affluent Western presence, the T-shirt is very old and faded. People play draughts with bottle tops, carry loads on their heads and travel three on a motorbike (helmets not required) and in dugout canoes. There are hippos in the river, a water buffalo in a mudhole, antelopes and giraffes, a giant anthill of red earth and whitewater rapids.

Dr Jakkel said that when she first went to Africa, to the Congo to work in a refugee camp, all her expectations had been surpassed by the enormous number of sick people and the amount of work to do. But when the first shock passed, out came her camera. She said at the opening of her exhibition, which is called "This is My Africa", that she felt the need to show the world how many people need and are waiting for help, but also how much beauty and experience await the traveller.

The photos are intended not just to show lovely near-natural landscapes but also the difficulties encountered with healing and the everyday struggles of life, which can be faced by joyful communities with friendly smiles. It is not horror, it is the reality of Africa.

The African Union that supported her trips is a non-profit organisation dedicated to international aid and development activities focusing on the continent. Its mission has been to support development there with the help of the countries' own resources by empowering communities and populations. The organisation supports programs that focus on education, child and youth protection, health and social care, and cultural, scientific and academic development.

0. Dr Anna Jakkel worked in Africa as a(n) ...

- A. organiser.
- B. photographer.
- C. volunteer.

1. She took photos of ...

- A. everyday people.
- B. medical problems.
- C. village scenes.

2. Her photos show ...

- A. little influence from the West.

- B. peaceful landscapes.
- C. typical African vehicles.

3. On her first visit, Dr Jakkel ...

- A. had high expectations.
- B. found shocking circumstances.
- C. was amazed by the beauty of Africa.

4. She found that local people handle hardships ...

- A. in a positive way.
- B. realistically.
- C. with great difficulty.

5. The African Union ... to help.

- A. gives financial support
- B. tries to rely on local resources
- C. sponsors employment programmes